

success at the global level, particularly with a view towards the Olympics in 2028.

To this end, a two-day sports conclave titled "Chak De! Bihar – 2028" was held on 28th and 29th April 2022, bringing together national and international sports professionals. Experts in sports administration, talent scouting, sports infrastructure, sports sciences, and scientific coaching gathered to share their knowledge and experiences. The objective was to develop a robust, forward-looking sports policy for Bihar, one with long-term goals but a sharp focus on immediate action. This conclave marked the beginning of Bihar's journey towards revitalising its sports heritage. With strategic planning, it aspires to establish itself as a significant player in the global sports arena once again. 'Mission Olympics 2028' represents not only a goal for the state but a vision for the future of Indian sports: a vision to transform sports into a widespread movement and create a supportive ecosystem for the holistic development of sports and fitness in Bihar. The mission is to identify young talent early and provide them with long-term, sustainable training using cutting-edge sports infrastructure, sports sciences, and data analytics, enabling athletes to compete on the international stage.

Objectives

- ✓ To identify, nurture, and retain sporting talent across Bihar.
- ✓ To achieve excellence in national and international competitions.

- ✓ To organise competitions at various levels, ensuring athletes gain essential match experience.
- ✓ To develop world-class, eco-friendly, and cost-effective sports infrastructure, with the ultimate goal of establishing Bihar as a major sports hub.

Roadmap

The proposed three-tier system to nurture talent involves: Feeder Centres (for school-aged children), Centres of Excellence (for college athletes), and High-Performance Academies (for professionals). The success depends heavily on providing athletes with adequate competition at various levels to enhance their skills and competitive edge. The more they compete, the more they develop competence and confidence.

There is a proposal to conduct 25-30 competitions annually, including rural sports, school games, and inter-district/inter-state tournaments.

The importance of sports sciences was emphasised repeatedly. Establishing a Sports Science Centre was deemed a fundamental requirement for scientific, injury-free training.

The roles of sports medicine, sports psychology, and sports nutrition were also emphasised as critical in shaping future Olympians. The involvement of parents is essential, particularly in encouraging girl children to participate in sports. One-to-one interactions with parents will be prioritised to help them understand the long-term benefits of sports for their children.

The recruitment of coaches was

